

Industrial Revolution

- 1.** The process of change that transformed Britain first and then other countries from agricultural to industrial economics.
- 2.** These new machines required factories to house them, at first near rivers for water power and then, when the steam engine was invented (by James Watt in 1769), near coalfields.
- 3.** England, an agricultural country was now turned into a manufacturing country. The production increased manifold. Things were available at cheaper rates. Improved methods of communication followed.
- 4.** The economic progress and industrialisation of England influenced the social & cultural life of the people. It had far-reaching effects on the political history of England.
- 5.** By 1850 the Industrial Revolution had penetrated into Belgium, France, Germany, Switzerland and USA.. By 1900 it had extended to Sweden, Italy, Russia, Japan & Argentina. Presently it is penetrating into China, India and Africa.